



CHATTING AND SMALL TALK



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
1EKH-J1LB-F52

**1**

Warm-up

Talk to your partner for five minutes about what you did last weekend.

2

Idioms

Match the following idiomatic expressions to their correct meaning and invent a sentence with each idiom:

1. Two months after Tom left her, Janet married another man on the rebound.
 2. I don't want everyone to know about this, so please keep it to yourself.
 3. I don't mind lending him money from time to time, but this is getting beyond a joke!
 4. My flatmate is really driving me up the wall! He never does any cleaning.
 5. I have my final exam tomorrow. Keep your fingers crossed for me!
-
- a. do not tell other people about this secret
 - b. making me very angry
 - c. starting a romantic relationship with somebody new while recovering from a previous relationship break-up
 - d. starting to become annoying
 - e. wish me good luck

3

Social expressions

Now listen to 5 dialogues and match them to each of the situations below.

Audio





- a. Tell someone a secret.
- b. Start a trivial conversation.
- c. Gossip about someone or something.
- d. Give someone a compliment.
- e. Moan about something.

Look at the following words and expressions from the dialogues. Match them to their functions:

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| 1. Please keep this to yourself. | a. <i>asking someone not to tell others something you have said</i> |
| 2. Apparently, .. | b. <i>introducing something surprising or interesting</i> |
| 3. You have my word. | c. <i>introducing something you have been told (although you are not certain it's true)</i> |
| 4. Why don't you ..? | d. <i>making a promise to somebody</i> |
| 5. Guess what? | e. <i>making a suggestion</i> |
| 6. That's very kind of you. | f. <i>replying to a compliment</i> |
| 7. Nice weather today, isn't it? | g. <i>responding to a suggestion which you think is ridiculous</i> |
| 8. You must be joking. | h. <i>starting a conversation</i> |

Now complete the dialogues with the expressions above:

Mark: Hey, Emma, _____¹ I have some very interesting news about Maria.

Emma: What?

Mark: _____² she has a new boyfriend.

Emma: Really? But hasn't she just split up with Nick?

Mark: I think she must be on the rebound.

Mark: Hey Emma, We're going to organise a party for Tom's birthday.

Emma: Great!

Mark: Yes, but _____³. It's a surprise party and we wouldn't want him to find out.

Emma: I won't tell a soul. _____⁴.

Simon: Hi Alice, sorry I'm late. I was stuck in traffic again for almost half an hour this time. It's getting beyond a joke.

Alice: _____⁵ take the underground?

Simon: _____⁶! The tube really drives me up the wall. It's so overcrowded these days.



Simon: Your hair looks really nice today.

Alice: Thank you. _____⁷.

Simon: Would you like to go out for a coffee this weekend?

Mark: _____⁸?

Emma: Yes. Lovely. I hope it stays like this for the rest of the weekend.

Mark: Keep your fingers crossed!

4

Grammar - Question tags

Read the following information on using question tags:

When we **invite someone to agree** with us, for example to emphasize a statement or start a conversation, we can add question tag to a statement, e.g. *Nice weather today, isn't it?*

Question tags can also be used to **ask real questions**, for example when you want to make a suggestion, ask for something or check that your information is correct, e.g. *Let's go out for a drink, shall we?*

You're coming to the party tonight, aren't you?

You don't know where Anne is, do you?

Listen and notice the difference in intonation:

Inviting agreement: *Lovely day, isn't it?*

Checking/asking for things or information: *It's time to go home, isn't it?*

Inviting agreement: *Tom isn't coming, is he?*

Checking/asking for things or information: *You don't have a dictionary I could borrow, do you?*

Question tags are formed with an **auxiliary verb** (have, was, will, shall etc.), **do/does** for the **present simple**, and **did** for **past simple**.

Complete the following rules by crossing out the incorrect alternative:

We normally use a positive/negative question tag after a positive sentence and a positive/negative question tag after a negative sentence.



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Grammar practice

Now complete the following sentences with question tags. Read your answers aloud and listen to check.

Audio



1. Excuse me, you don't have the time on you, _____ ? / Yes, it's 3 o'clock.
2. She's a very pretty woman, _____ ? / Yes, she's gorgeous.
3. Let's go to the cinema, _____ ? / Sure. Good idea.
4. He didn't come in to work today, _____ ? / Yes, I know. And it's not the first time!
5. Paula won't pass her exams, _____ ? / Probably not. She's hardly studied at all.
6. I saw Martin yesterday in the pub. / But he's supposed to be on holiday, _____ ?
7. It was a great match yesterday, _____ ? / Yeah, fantastic result for England.
8. Marta's been absent quite a lot recently, _____ ? / Yeah, she probably has the flu again.
9. Excuse me, you don't have a dictionary I could borrow, _____ ? / Yes, I do. Here you are.
10. He was very cheerful this morning, _____ ? / Yes, I know. He probably had a good weekend.

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Role play

In pairs, write mini-dialogues for three of the following situations using language from this lesson. Act out the dialogues when they are ready:

1. There has been a scandal involving the president of your country. Gossip about it.
2. You are waiting to board a plane at an airport. The flight has already been delayed by two hours. You decide to start a conversation with the person sitting next to you in the departure lounge.
3. You see your friend for the first time in a month. He/she has a new look. Give him/her a compliment.
4. You are going to move to another town and you decide to tell your best friend, but you want him/her to keep it a secret for now.
5. You want to know the time and you decide to ask a stranger on the street.
6. You are discussing with a friend where to go out for the evening. Your friend suggests the most expensive restaurant in town.
7. You are going shopping with a friend. It is late and you think that the shopping centre closes at 9pm, but you are not sure.